

Urban75.org, among other things, has information on drugs, punch and football. Among this is a link called 'useless' that lists over 25 utterly useless games (some are fun, though!). The worst among these really is the World Mouse clicking championship. To their credit, the site base-line warns you these are useless games (and other links!).

All one has to do is click on the given button and see how many times you can click in 10 seconds. It can get addictive for about 30 seconds (that's about three attempts) but soon, the novelty wears off, your IQ comes back to normal and you decide to hit [Ctrl]+[W]. Please avoid. But we know you won't listen!

Some of the other totally inane games include a certain Mr Insult who will shout insults (some as banal as "What are you, insane?") for anything you type. What makes this mind-numbing is the fact that the insults are not even fresh, and the same old ones get repeated every single time. Sheesh!

Mr Insult can also become a purist when it comes to the language and insult you in Shakespearean English. Why is that interesting? The insults fade away à la Star Wars titles. To his credit, he manages to keep them scrolling for a long time but once again, the uniqueness wears off after about 6.5 seconds and your IQ rises yet again, and you will rush for [Ctrl]+[W]. We suggest you keep your fingers ready for [Alt]+[F4]!



www.urban75.org/useless

an inspiration that this may someday be the direction that technology will take us," she said.

Whether the patent will revolutionise the way we think of movies remains to be seen, but one must remember that when talkies first arrived, a famous personality said, "Who wants to hear people in movies talk?"

HARD DRIVE CUSHIONING

Sony Adds 'Airbag' To MP3 Player

Late in April, Sony shipped a hard drive-based personal digital music player adding a removable battery and an anti-impact system to the hard disk as new features.

The NW-HD5 is equipped with a 20 GB drive, which has a 'G Sensor' that detects sudden drops and cushions the



storage medium to prevent damage and data loss. IBM recently added such a mechanism to its ThinkPad hard drives, as did Apple with its laptops, but this is the first time the technique has been applied to portable music players.

The player went on sale in Japan on April 21 for around ¥35,000 (Rs 14,000).■

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Blog WATCH

This month in the Blogosphere: Russ Nemhauser finds out the hard way why he should have had power backup; A1Great takes a look at pop-ups; Jason Salas puts up a primer for podcasting newbies; and Science Library Pad puts down thoughts on linkblogging

A1Great
<http://a1great.com/>

On popups and such

The Bored site is doing gangbuster business right now, attracting a lot of users and site submissions. One of those submissions came from a webmaster whose game site offered a lot of fun stuff, but managed to throw a popup into my browser, despite having that particular feature disabled in Firefox.

So I got into it with the webmaster a little bit, saying I wouldn't link to anything that deliberately breaks a setting on my browser. He responded with the suggestion that he had to pay for hosting and bandwidth, and thus was entitled to throwing any advertising in there that he saw fit.

Jason Salas' Weblog
<http://weblogs.asp.net/jasonsalas>

A primer on podcasting for newbies

An earlier casting call I made to co-host a weekly podcast dedicated to all things ASP.NET has gotten a pretty decent response from the Microsoft community, with one thing common: all respondents admitted they had heard of the podcast platform or have listened to a podcast, but hadn't ever produced one themselves. No sweat! Here are two great links that show how easy it is:

☐ Jake Ludington's podcast tutorial: great primer for first-time audio newbies

☐ Harold Gilchrist profiles the audioblogging revolution: awesome breakdown of the differences in the RSS feed for podcasting

Russ Nemhauser
<http://weblogs.asp.net/russnem/>

The Belated Active Directory Corruption Post

I had a power outage and my Active Directory got corrupted. I'd (been using) Windows' built-in NTBACKUP utility to back up the network shares that contained user-created data. What I never knew is that the NTBACKUP utility can be used to back up what is called "system state".

If you have a relatively quiet domain like mine here at home, you should be backing up your system state about once a month.

Science Library Pad
<http://scilib.typepad.com/>

Thoughts on linkblogging

Mostly I do what is now called "linkblogging". I just copy and paste a link of interest to me along with a select few paragraphs.

Also it depends on your target audience. If you're blogging for yourself and a few friends, they probably haven't seen the links you're mentioning. If you're blogging for a target audience of people who are sucking down hundreds of Bloglines feeds per day, they probably HAVE seen any link you're going to uncover.